

Name: _____

Date: _____

PROPORTION, (PROPORTION IN CONTEXT)

LO: I can solve real-world proportion problems involving recipes, maps, scales, and exchange rates.

Proportion in real life

Proportion in context means scaling quantities up or down while keeping the same ratio between ingredients, distances, or values.

Applications: Recipes (scaling ingredients), maps (scale factors), currency exchange, and mixing ratios.

Quick examples

●	Scale 1:50000 means 1 cm = 50000 cm = 500 m	map scale
●	Recipe for 4 for 6: multiply by 1.5	scale factor
●	£1 = .25 means £40 = 0	exchange rate
●	Scale 1:50000 means 1 cm = 50 m	forgot a zero: 500 m

Key idea

Find the scale factor (new ÷ original) and multiply all quantities by it.

Scale factor = $\frac{\text{new amount}}{\text{original}}$

Then multiply each ingredient/measurement by SF

MODELLED EXAMPLES

Study each example carefully before attempting the practice questions.

Example 1 – scaling a recipe

A recipe for 4 uses 200g flour, 100g sugar, 2 eggs. Make it for 6.

Scale factor: $6 \div 4 = 1.5$

Flour: $200 \times 1.5 = 300\text{g}$, Sugar: $100 \times 1.5 = 150\text{g}$

Eggs: $2 \times 1.5 = 3$

300g flour, 150g sugar, 3 eggs

Multiply every ingredient by the same scale factor.

Example 2 – map scale

A map has scale 1:25000. Two towns are 8 cm apart on the map. Find the real distance in km.

$8 \text{ cm} \times 25000 = 200000 \text{ cm}$

$200000 \text{ cm} = 2000 \text{ m}$

$2000 \text{ m} = 2 \text{ km}$

= 2 km

Convert from cm to km: divide by 100000.

Example 3 – currency exchange

£1 = 1.15 euros. Convert £85 to euros.

Multiply by the exchange rate

85×1.15

$= 97.75 \text{ euros}$

= 97.75 euros

To convert from pounds to euros, multiply by the rate.

Example 4 – best buy using proportion

Shop A: 500ml for £2.40. Shop B: 750ml for £3.30. Which is better value?

Shop A: $2.40 \div 500 = 0.48\text{p per ml}$

Shop B: $3.30 \div 750 = 0.44\text{p per ml}$

Shop B is cheaper per ml

Shop B is better value

Compare unit prices to find the best deal.

YOUR TURN – PRACTICE (deliberate practice)

1. Scaling recipes

Scale the recipe from 4 servings to the target.

- a) 200g flour for 4. Amount for 10?
- b) 150ml milk for 4. Amount for 6?
- c) 3 eggs for 4. Eggs for 12?
- d) 80g butter for 4. Amount for 3?

2. Map scales

Calculate real distances from map measurements.

- a) Scale 1:50000. Map distance 6 cm. Real distance?
- b) Scale 1:25000. Map distance 12 cm. Real distance?
- c) Scale 1:100000. Real distance 8 km. Map distance?
- d) Scale 1:20000. Map distance 4.5 cm. Real distance?

3. Currency exchange

Convert using the given exchange rate.

- a) £1 = .25. Convert £60 to dollars
- b) £1 = 1.15 euros. Convert £200 to euros
- c) £1 = .25. Convert 00 to pounds
- d) £1 = 1.15 euros. Convert 460 euros to pounds

4. Mixing and ratios

Use proportion to solve.

- a) Concrete mix: 1 cement : 3 sand. Need 20 kg total. How much cement?
- b) Paint: 3 red : 2 white = pink. Need 2.5 L total. How much red?
- c) Squash: 1 part cordial to 4 parts water. Make 2 litres. Cordial needed?
- d) Model scale 1:72. Real plane 36 m. Model length?

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS – SPOT THE MISTAKE

Each statement shows a student's answer. Tick () the ones that are correct. If it is wrong, write the correct answer.

a) Scale 1:25000 means 1 cm represents 250 m ☐

Correct answer: _____

Reason: _____

b) To scale a recipe from 4 to 6, add 2 to each ingredient ☐

Correct answer: _____

Reason: _____

c) To convert £ to euros, multiply by the exchange rate ☐

Correct answer: _____

Reason: _____

d) Scale 1:50000 means 1 cm = 50 m ☐

Correct answer: _____

Reason: _____

e) The scale factor for 4 servings to 6 is 1.5 ☐

Correct answer: _____

Reason: _____

6. CHALLENGE – WORD PROBLEMS (apply your skills)

a) A recipe for **6 people** uses: 450g chicken, 200g rice, 150ml sauce, 3 peppers. You have **750g chicken** and want to use it all. How much of each other ingredient do you need? How many people does this serve?

Expression: _____

Simplified: _____

b) On a map with scale **1:50000**, a lake has area **12 cm²** on the map. Find the real area in km². If a runner goes around the lake and it measures **14 cm** on the map, how far do they actually run?

Expression: _____

Simplified: _____

TOP TIPS

Read the question carefully. Show all your working step by step.
Check your answer makes sense.

CHECK YOUR WORK

Have I shown all my working clearly?

Did I check my answer using a different method?

Does my answer look reasonable?

